

Get the Response of a POST API Request

Creating a Booking with POST in Postman

Hands-On	6
Scenario	Get the response of POST API Request
Tool	Postman (Desktop or Web)
Method	POST
Endpoint URL	https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/booking
Auth	Bearer Token (from /auth POST response)
Duration	20 minutes
Prerequisite	Workspace, Collection, and a valid auth token

Objective

The objective of this assignment is to send a **POST** request from Postman to create a new booking on the Restful Booker API. The request carries a JSON body with booking details and uses a **Bearer Token** (obtained from a previous `/auth` call) for authorization. After clicking **Send**, the response — which contains the new booking id and the booking details — is verified.

Note on Authorization

The Restful Booker API only requires a Bearer Token for **PUT**, **PATCH** and **DELETE** on a booking. The **POST /booking** endpoint actually accepts requests *without* any token and returns **200 OK**. However, this assignment intentionally exercises the Bearer Token flow so that the token obtained from `/auth` can be carried forward and reused. The same pattern is reused in real APIs where almost every write operation does require a token.

Steps to Send the POST Request

1

Go to the Right Workspace

Open Postman (desktop or web) and sign in if not already logged in.

Click the **Workspaces** dropdown in the upper-left corner.

Select the workspace created earlier (for example, *Bitcoin API Tests*).

2 Go to the Right Collection

In the left sidebar, click the **Collections** tab.

Locate and click the collection where the previous requests were saved (for example, *Bitcoin Rate API Tests*).

3 Add a New Request

Click the **Add a request** link inside the collection, or use the three-dot (...) menu next to the collection name and select **Add request**.

4 New Tab Opens with the Empty Request

Postman opens a new request tab in the central panel.

By default the request is named *Untitled Request* with method **GET** and an empty URL.

5 Give the Request a Meaningful Name

Click on *Untitled Request* at the top of the tab (or right-click the request in the sidebar and choose **Rename**).

Use a clear, descriptive name such as *Create Booking* or *POST Restful Booker Booking*.

Save with **Ctrl + S** (or **Cmd + S** on Mac).

6 Set the HTTP Method to POST

Click the **method dropdown** on the left of the URL field.

Choose **POST** from the list. POST is used to **create** a new resource on the server.

7 Set the Bearer Token in the Authorization Tab

First, run the previous POST `/auth` request with the body `{"username": "admin", "password": "password123"}`. The response contains a JSON field called **token**.

Copy the token value from that response.

Switch to the new **Create Booking** request and click the **Authorization** tab.

From the **Type** dropdown, choose **Bearer Token**.

Paste the copied token into the **Token** field on the right. Postman will automatically add a `Authorization: Bearer <token>` header to the outgoing request.

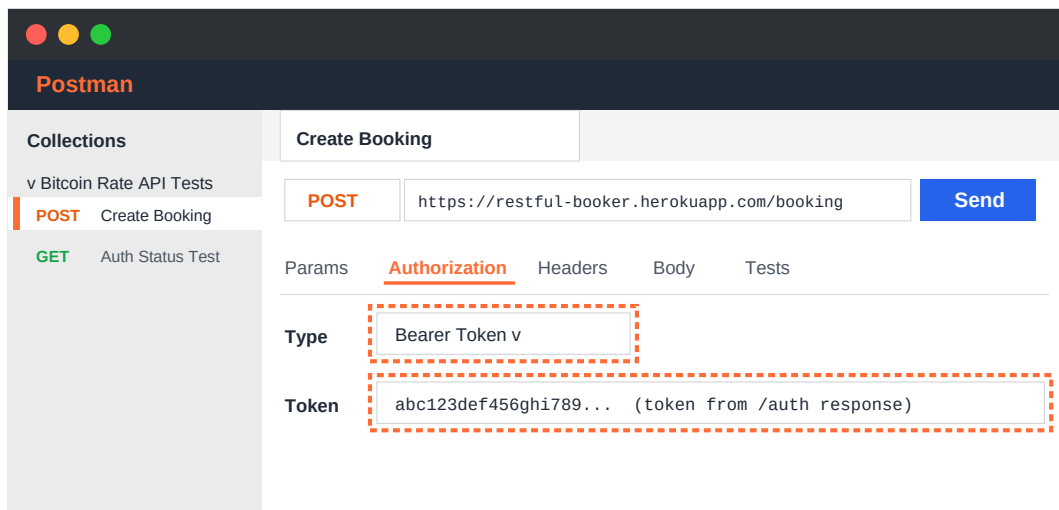


Figure 1 — **Authorization** tab with type set to **Bearer Token** and the token pasted into the **Token** field.

8 Set the Request URL

Click the URL field on the request line and enter:

<https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/booking>

9 Add the Request Body (Sample Booking JSON)

Click the **Body** tab below the URL line.

Select the **raw** radio option and choose **JSON** from the format dropdown on the right. This sets the Content-Type: application/json header automatically.

Paste the booking payload shown in the **Sample Request Body** section below into the editor.

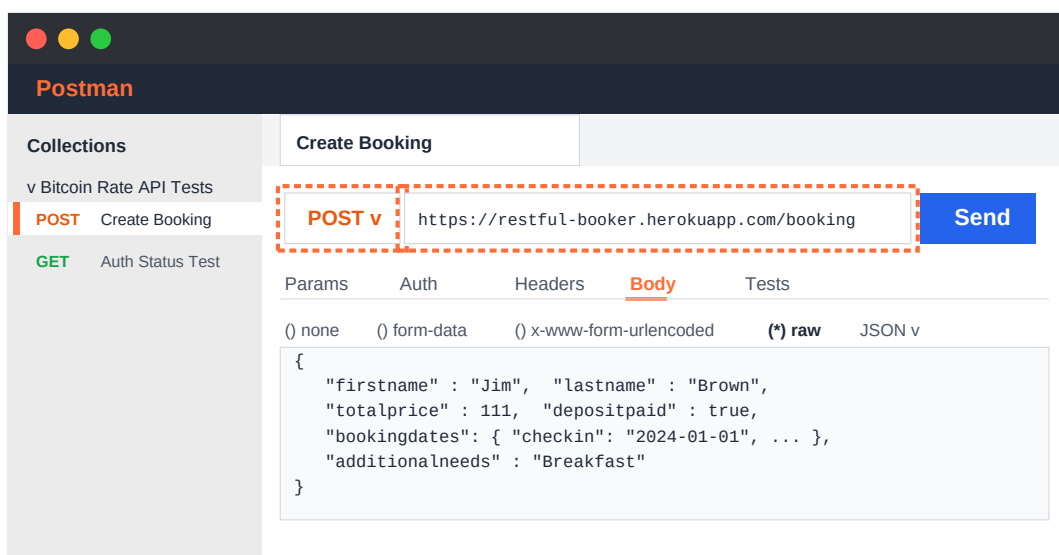


Figure 2 — Request configured: method **POST**, URL set, **Body** tab in **raw / JSON** mode, payload entered.

Sample Request Body (Input)

If no input file is provided, use this standard Restful Booker sample payload as the request body:

```
{
  "firstname" : "Jim",
  "lastname" : "Brown",
  "totalprice" : 111,
  "depositpaid" : true,
  "bookingdates" : {
    "checkin" : "2024-01-01",
    "checkout" : "2024-01-05"
  },
  "additionalneeds" : "Breakfast"
}
```

10 Click the “Send” Button and Verify the Response

Click the blue **Send** button on the right side of the URL bar.

Postman dispatches the POST request and displays the server's response in the lower **Response** panel.

Verify the following on the response:

- **Status** — should be **200 OK** in green.
- **Body** — contains a **bookingid** (a number) and a nested **booking** object echoing back the data sent.
- **Time / Size** — the request typically completes in well under a second.

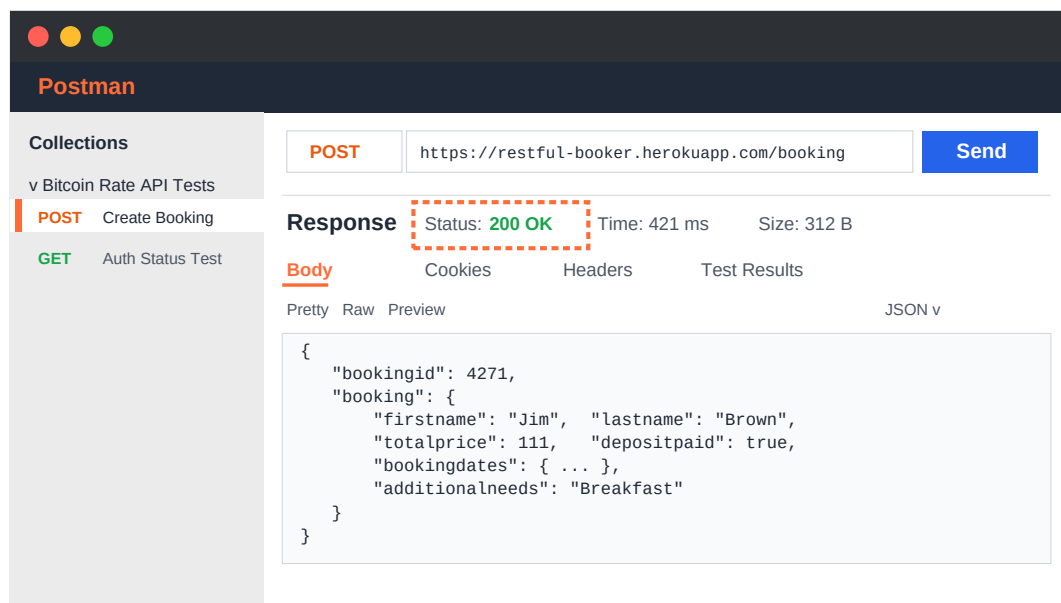


Figure 3 — Response panel with status **200 OK**, the new booking id, and the echoed booking details.

Expected Response

On success, the server returns **HTTP 200 OK** together with a JSON payload containing a generated **bookingid** and the full booking echoed back:

```
{
  "bookingid": 4271,
  "booking": {
    "firstname": "Jim",
    "lastname": "Brown",
    "totalprice": 111,
```

```
    "depositpaid": true,  
    "bookingdates": { ... },  
    "additionalneeds": "Breakfast"  
  }  
}
```

The **bookingid** is generated server-side and will differ on each call. Save it — it will be needed to GET, PUT or DELETE the booking in upcoming assignments.

Verification Checklist

- 1 Status code is **200 OK** (green).
- 2 Response body contains a **bookingid** (positive integer).
- 3 The **booking** object inside the response matches the data that was sent in the request body.
- 4 Bearer Token is visible under the **Authorization** tab and the request was sent with the Authorization header.
- 5 Request is saved (**Ctrl + S / Cmd + S**) inside the collection in the left sidebar.

Conclusion

A POST request to create a hotel booking has been successfully sent and the response verified. This exercise covered the full request workflow — setting the HTTP method, supplying a Bearer Token in the **Authorization** tab, sending a JSON body in the **Body** tab, and reading a structured response from the server. The **bookingid** returned in the response is the resource identifier that will be reused in upcoming GET / PUT / DELETE assignments to retrieve, update and remove the same booking.